MANALIVE EXPEDITION

THE JOURNEY

# WEEK 5
# THE NEW NAME

ASK YOUR FATHER

DRAFT FOR REVIEW

October 12, 2026

WEEK 5 OVERVIEW

# WHAT THIS WEEK IS FOR

Week 5 walks a man back through the Healing Prayer and the New Name session, and the thirty minutes of silence that followed. Two days take the wound back to Jesus. The rest of the week is about the name: fathering, the names he's lived under, and asking the Father what He thinks of him. By Sunday he should be able to say:

> *I brought my wound to Jesus, and I wasn't alone there. I've lived under names that didn't come from my Father. He knows the man He had in mind when He made me, and I still need Him to father me. I can ask Him what He thinks of me. He may answer with a name, a word, a phrase, a picture, a verse, or something that unfolds over time. I don't have to force it. If nothing has come yet, I haven't failed. I want to keep asking.*

## HOW EVERY DAY WORKS

| | |
|---|---|
| **READING** | About 150 words. A quick reminder of what happened at camp and where it shows up at home. |
| **AUDIO** | About 2 minutes from John. A handle to carry, one layer deeper, and a story. |
| **WITH DAD** | 5 minutes on weekdays this week. Saturday is 10, a small Covenant of Silence at home. Sunday is 3. |
| **SHARE** | Optional. Opens the alumni group with his thought ready to paste. |
| **NOTES** | Private. Day 35 shows him this week's notes in one place. |
| **WEEKLY EMAIL** | Sunday evening. One heart line per day. |

## THE WEEK AT A GLANCE

| DAY | TITLE | CARRY THIS | WITH DAD |
|---|---|---|---|
| 29 · Mon | Not Alone There | **Not alone there** | 5 min |
| 30 · Tue | What Is True | **What's true, Jesus?** | 5 min |
| 31 · Wed | Still Need a Father | **Father me in this** | 5 min |
| 32 · Thu | My Name Is Gladiator | **The role isn't the name** | 5 min |
| 33 · Fri | The Yellow Passport | **Who gets naming rights?** | 5 min |
| 34 · Sat | What Do You Think of Me? | **What do You think of me?** | 10 min |
| 35 · Sun | Not a Test | **Not a test. A conversation.** | 3 min |

# NOT ALONE THERE

## READING

Remember how the room felt after the Wound session?

The lights went low. Nobody was talking. Then a leader started to pray, slow, with long stretches of quiet. He wasn't teaching. He was walking you back to the place that hurt, and asking Jesus to come in there with you.

Maybe that was the most real ten minutes of your weekend. Maybe you sat there, felt nothing, and wondered what was wrong with you. Both happened in that room. Both are okay.

That prayer wasn't trying to fix you in fifteen minutes. It was showing you that the place you've always been alone in, you don't have to be alone in anymore.

This week we pick up where camp left off. First, the healing. Then the bigger question: who does your Father say you are?

Today, just the first step. Go back to that place, and invite Him in.

> **CARRY THIS**
> **Not alone there.**

## AUDIO SCRIPT JOHN

> No story today. Just you and me for a minute, and then you and Him.
>
> At camp, a lot of men find their wound and then do the most natural thing in the world. They shut the door on it again. It hurt to look at. So they look, they nod, and they lock it back up. At home it's even easier.
>
> Here's what I've come to believe. The wound isn't the whole problem. The worst part is that you were alone in it. Nobody came. Nobody said, that wasn't okay. So you made sense of it by yourself, as a kid, the best you could.
>
> That's why the healing prayer started where it did. Not with getting over it. With inviting Jesus into it.
>
> And hear me. You don't have to see anything. Some men picture Him right there. Some just sense He's close. Some feel nothing and wonder if they did it wrong. You didn't. The

invitation is the thing. He takes it from there.

If you never found a clear wound at camp, that's okay too. Don't go digging. Just ask Him to take you where He wants to go. He's gentle. He won't drag you anywhere.

**So here's what I want you to carry today. Not alone there.**

In your five minutes, go back to that place, or let Him pick the place. Then say it simply. Jesus, come in here with me. And stay a while. Don't rush out.

If it gets heavy, that's not failure. Call one of the guys. That's what they're for.

You were alone there once. You don't have to be anymore. Not alone there.

## WITH DAD 5 MINUTES

Go back to the place that hurt, or ask Him to take you where He wants. Then pray: *Jesus, come into this place with me.* Stay there. You don't have to see or feel anything. Inviting Him is enough.

## SHARE

Where do you go to get quiet with God? Post a picture of your spot.

## YOUR NOTES

# WHAT IS TRUE

## READING

At camp, after you invited Jesus in, the prayer kept going. A few more steps, and three of them matter a lot this week.

First, you asked Him what that wound said to you. Not what happened. What you came to believe about you because it happened.

Then you told Him you don't believe it anymore. That you're done agreeing with it.

Then the part most of us skip. You asked Him what is true.

That last step is the one that heals. It's not you talking yourself into the opposite. It's not a poster on the wall. It's Him answering, because He was there and He saw all of it.

Sometimes His answer is a word. Sometimes a picture, a verse, a quiet sense. Sometimes nothing yet.

If you got stuck on any of those steps at camp, you're not behind. That's what today is for.

> CARRY THIS
> **What's true, Jesus?**

## AUDIO SCRIPT JOHN

> Here's the thing about a lie. You can believe one for thirty years and never once say it out loud.
>
> Fifteen years ago, I was in a dark place. I'd been through a divorce. I'd lost my job. I was struggling just to make money. And that old belief from when I was a kid, that I was a failure? I was sure it was true.
>
> If I could sit down with that guy today, I'd tell him: Bro, you're not a failure. You've made some bad choices. You chose your way into this. You can choose your way out.
>
> But I didn't figure that out on my own. It came slowly, through my band of brothers. When I did something good, they loved me. When I did something bad, they loved me. They never left. They didn't condemn me or talk about me behind my back. They challenged me, sure.

But the challenge was always to get at my heart. What are you thinking? How are you feeling about yourself?

And over time, their love let me see it. I am not a failure.

That's how it works. A message gets in early, usually through something that hurt. And after a while it stops sounding like a message. It just sounds like the truth about you. You don't argue with it. You live by it.

That's why the prayer at camp went the way it did. First you ask Jesus what the message was. You can't put down something you can't see.

Then you tell Him you're done with it. Not by shouting. Not by trying really hard. Just honestly. Jesus, I don't believe that anymore.

And then you ask. Jesus, what's true?

That's the part I want you to hear today. You don't get to make up the truth. If you made it up, you'd just make up something nicer, and the old message would eat it for breakfast. The truth has to come from Him. Sometimes He says it straight to you. Sometimes He says it through men who won't leave. He was there. He knows what it was, and He knows who you are.

**So here's what I want you to carry today. What's true, Jesus?**

Take it back to that place from yesterday. Ask Him what it told you. Tell Him you're done with it. Then ask, and wait.

It might be a word. It might be a picture. It might be quiet for now. Quiet doesn't mean no. Sometimes the answer shows up on a Thursday afternoon when you're not even asking.

What's true, Jesus? Ask Him.

## WITH DAD 5 MINUTES

Go back to the place from yesterday. Ask: *Jesus, what did that tell me about me?* When you see it, say: *I don't believe that anymore.* Then ask: *Jesus, what's true?* Wait. Write down whatever comes, even if it's small. If nothing comes yet, that's okay.

## SHARE

A verse, a song, or a line that's been telling you the truth lately.

## YOUR NOTES

# STILL NEED A FATHER

## READING

When the healing prayer ended, the next session didn't change the subject. It went straight to fathering.

That can sound strange to a grown man. You've got bills, a job, maybe kids of your own. Isn't fathering for little boys?

Here's what camp said: you never graduate from it. Even a great dad can only take you partway. He can teach you to throw a ball, show up for work, treat people right. But he can't tell you everything about who you are. He doesn't know all of it. Only the Father who made you does.

And if your dad couldn't give you much, God can father what was missed. Not all at once. Over time, as you let Him.

This isn't another week about your dad. It's about letting God be one.

Today, start with the stuff you honestly don't know how to do.

> CARRY THIS
> **Father me in this.**

## AUDIO SCRIPT JOHN

> I want to tell you where I need fathering right now.
>
> Most days, what I still need is for it to get all the way down into the core of me that I'm loved. As I am.
>
> My brothers have helped with that. I've changed a lot. But there's still that old voice. You're not good enough. You're a bad person. It still shows up.
>
> So I need God to keep fathering me. Teaching me how to live like a son. One that's loved.
>
> I'm not saying that because I'm the guy who's supposed to say it. I've been walking with God a long time, and I still need that.
>
> Most men hate needing help. We think it means we're behind. So we fake it. We figure it out alone, and we call that being a man.

> But think about what a good father actually does. He doesn't just love you from across the room. He shows you how. Here, hold it like this. Not that way. Try again. And somewhere in there, he tells you who you are. You've got this. You're mine.
>
> Most of us didn't get enough of that. Some of us got almost none. And even the guys with a great dad ran out of him at some point. That's not a knock on him. No man can take you all the way.
>
> God can. He doesn't run out. And He's not annoyed that you still need Him.
>
> **So here's what I want you to carry today. Father me in this.**
>
> Make a list. Your marriage. Your money. Your kids. Your temper. Your body. Your work. Whatever's true. Then pick one and say it. Dad, father me in this. I don't know how. Show me.
>
> Then listen like a son. Not like a man waiting on a memo from headquarters.
>
> Father me in this. He loves being asked.

## WITH DAD 5 MINUTES

Write a short list: *Dad, I need You to father me in…* Then pick one and ask: *Father, how do You want to father me in this?* Listen like a son. Whatever comes, even one small next step, write it down.

## SHARE

Finish the sentence: *I still need fathering in…* Keep it as general as you like.

## YOUR NOTES

# MY NAME IS GLADIATOR

## READING

Remember the Gladiator scene? The emperor walks down onto the sand and asks the masked fighter his name.

His first answer: *"My name is Gladiator."*

That's the name he's been handed. Everything that used to tell him who he was is gone. His rank. His freedom. His family. Now he's a slave who fights for a crowd.

Then he turns his back on the most powerful man in the world. The emperor demands it again. And he takes off the helmet and says who he really is. General. Father. Husband. His circumstances changed. He didn't.

Most of us answer with the first line. Ask a man who he is and he tells you what he does. Contractor. Sales. Dad. Retired.

Those are good things. But they're roles. You're not a job with a man inside it. You're a man God knit together on purpose, and you bring that man into every role you've got.

> **CARRY THIS**
> **The role isn't the name.**

## AUDIO SCRIPT JOHN

> Let me walk you through your roles today.
>
> Six in the morning, you're a husband, or a roommate, or the only one up. Somebody needs something from you before coffee.
>
> Seven, you're a dad, or an uncle, or the guy at the gas station holding the door.
>
> Eight to five, you're whatever your business card says. Boss. Employee. Owner. The guy they call when it breaks.
>
> Evening, you're a coach, a son checking on his mom, a neighbor, a friend who owes somebody a call.
>
> Same man all day. Different hats.

Here's the trap. Most of us start to think the hats are us. Work goes well, I'm somebody. Lose the job, I'm nobody. The kids are a mess, so I must be one too. The role gets to tell you who you are.

That's what Maximus wouldn't let happen. They took his rank, his freedom, his family. They gave him a new name. And underneath it, he still knew who he was.

I want that. To know who I am deep enough that a bad quarter or a hard season doesn't get the last word.

And here's the good news. You don't have to invent that man. God already had him in mind. Not a generic man with a slightly different résumé. You. Particular. On purpose.

**So here's what I want you to carry today. The role isn't the name.**

Every time you switch hats today, notice it. Then ask Dad, who's the man under this hat? What do You see?

You bring the man into the role. Not the other way around.

The role isn't the name. Go ask Him about the man.

## WITH DAD 5 MINUTES

Name your roles out loud. Then ask: *Father, who is the man You had in mind under all of these?* Listen. If nothing comes yet, that's okay. You're just starting to ask.

## SHARE

Which role are you bringing your whole self into this week?

## YOUR NOTES

# THE YELLOW PASSPORT

## READING

Remember Jean Valjean at the bishop's door? Nineteen years of hard labor for stealing bread. He hands over his yellow passport and says, *"I can't read, but I know what it says."*

Convict. Dangerous. That's the name on the paper, and he's believed it so long he says it before anybody else can.

Most men carry a passport like that. Some names were said out loud, by a father, a coach, a kid on the bus. Others nobody had to say. You just figured them out from what happened. And after enough years, a name stops being a name. It becomes a script. You live it.

Then the bishop does what nobody else had done. He knows exactly what Valjean did, and he treats him like a different man anyway.

You don't have to say your old names to anybody today. Just notice who's been doing the naming.

> CARRY THIS
> **Who gets naming rights?**

## AUDIO SCRIPT JOHN

> Valjean's not the only man who's carried a passport.
>
> After my arrest, I was the guy with a record.
>
> It cost me my marriage. It cost me my job. And then I found out how hard it is to get a job when you've got a record. Before that, I'd been incredibly successful in sales. Now I couldn't even get hired.
>
> That paper went into every interview ahead of me. And every door that closed fed the same old voice. You're a failure. You're no good.
>
> Here's what gets me about that scene. Valjean doesn't just carry the paper. He introduces himself with it. Look, I'm a convict. He's so sure of the name, he hands it to you before you can find out for yourself.

We do that. We walk into a room already expecting to be seen as the guy on the paper. Whatever yours says.

And some of what's on there might even be true about what you did. Valjean did steal. The bishop never pretends he didn't. He just won't let that be the last word on who Valjean is.

That's the question this whole week turns on. Who gets the final say over who you are?

Not your wound. Not your worst day. Not your best day either. Your trophies don't get to name you any more than your failures do.

Only one voice knows the whole man. Everything you've done. Everything that was done to you. And everything He put in you before any of it happened. That's your Father.

**So here's what I want you to carry today. Who gets naming rights?**

When an old name shows up today, and it probably will, you don't have to win an argument with it. Just ask, who gave you the right? Then turn to Dad.

Tomorrow we're going to ask Him straight out what He thinks of you. Today, just notice who's been doing the talking.

Who gets naming rights? Not the passport. Him.

## WITH DAD 5 MINUTES

Ask Him: *Father, what names have I been living under that didn't come from You?* Write them down if you want. Nobody sees this but you. Then hand Him the page, and ask: *Who gets to name me?* Listen.

## SHARE

Who's a man whose words over you were life? Give him a shout-out.

## YOUR NOTES

# WHAT DO YOU THINK OF ME?

## READING

This is where camp was heading all along.

After Les Mis, the room went quiet, and you were sent out alone for thirty minutes with a few questions. *Father, what do You think of me? How do You see me? What words do You have for my heart? What is my New Name?*

Some men came back with a name. Some with a phrase, a picture, a verse. Some came back with nothing they could put into words. And some sat out there afraid. What if He doesn't say anything? Or worse, what if He agrees with every other voice?

Jesus answered that fear a long time ago. What father, if his son asks for a fish, hands him a snake?

Today is longer on purpose. Ten minutes. A small Covenant of Silence at your kitchen table or in your truck.

You're not taking a test. You're a son asking his Father a question.

CARRY THIS

**What do You think of me?**

## AUDIO SCRIPT JOHN

> I want to tell you what happened when I asked.
>
> By then I'd been in therapy for years. I knew my stuff. I could tell you exactly how I posed, what I hid behind, and why. I understood myself pretty well.
>
> But I'd never asked God what He thought of me. As a man.
>
> So during a session at camp, I asked Him. Father, what do You think of me?
>
> And here's what He said. *I've been waiting for you just to turn, so I could see the shadow of you turning back to Me. I've always loved you, and I always will. I don't love you because of what you've done or not done. I love you because of who you are. Because you're My son.*
>
> It floored me. It felt almost too good to be true.

Notice what that was. Not a grade. Not a list of what I'd done right, or everything I'd done wrong. A Father talking to his son about who I am to Him.

Now hear me. My story is not the standard. He might answer you with a name. Or a word, a phrase, a picture, a verse. Or something that unfolds over months. Some men hear something the first time they ask. Some ask for a long time. None of that makes one man more spiritual than another.

And I know some of you are scared to ask. Scared He'll be quiet. Scared He'll sound like everybody else. Ask anyway. He's not everybody else.

**So here's what I want you to carry today. What do You think of me?**

Take ten minutes. Find somewhere alone. Phone off. Ask Him plainly. Then listen, and write down whatever comes, even if it seems small, or strange, or too good. Don't force it. Don't grade it.

And if nothing comes today, you didn't fail. You asked. That's a son talking to his Father.

What do You think of me? Go ask Him.

## WITH DAD 10 MINUTES

Alone, phone off. Ask: *Father, what do You think of me? How do You see me? What words do You have for my heart?* If you want, ask Him about your New Name. Then listen, and write whatever comes: a name, a word, a phrase, a picture, a verse. Don't force it. If nothing comes today, you haven't failed. You asked, and He heard you.

## SHARE

What's harder for you: asking God what He thinks of you, or believing the answer?

## YOUR NOTES

# NOT A TEST

## READING

Five weeks home.

This week you went back to the place that hurt and invited Jesus in. You asked Him what was true. You let Him father you in the stuff you can't figure out. You noticed the roles, and the old names on the passport. And you asked the big question.

Maybe a name came at camp and it's still ringing. Maybe a word, a picture, a verse. Maybe nothing has come yet.

Hear this clearly: nothing yet is not failure. The name was never the point. The Father is. For some men the answer unfolds over months. Keep asking.

Your notes from this week are right below. Read back through them. Circle anything He said, even something small.

Today, rest.

And if one question is sitting with you, let it sit: *If my Father has good words for me, why does something keep trying to talk me out of them?*

Tomorrow we start there.

> **CARRY THIS**
> **Not a test. A conversation.**

## AUDIO SCRIPT JOHN

> Let's talk about the guys who didn't get a name.
>
> Every camp, some men come back from those thirty minutes with something. And some come back with nothing, and they sit around the fire listening to everybody else, thinking, what's wrong with me?
>
> Nothing is wrong with you. Let me tell you how it's gone for me.
>
> The name God gave me was Healer.

And when I heard it, I thought physical healing. Miracles. And that wasn't really happening in my life. So I didn't know what to do with it.

But I couldn't let it go. I kept coming back to it. God called me this. What does that mean? How is that alive in my life?

And over a series of years, I started to see it. Healing comes in a lot of ways. Spiritual. Emotional. Sitting with a man in the hardest moment of his life and walking with him through his own healing. That's healing too.

Now when I look at my life, I see myself as a healer. Just not the way I first pictured it.

It didn't land all at once. It unfolded. And I had to keep asking.

However yours is coming, here's what I want you to know. God isn't handing out grades. Hearing fast doesn't make a man mature. Hearing slow doesn't make him behind. And nobody gets to judge another man's name, or another man's quiet.

The name was never the prize. Knowing your Father has something to say about you, and wanting to keep asking Him, that's the prize.

**So here's what I want you to carry into this week. Not a test. A conversation.**

Today, rest. Read back through your notes. If you're still waiting on something, write the question down and put today's date next to it. You'll want to see that later.

Text one of the guys. Tell him what came, or tell him you're still asking. Either one is honest.

And sit with that question I left you. If He has good words for me, why does something keep trying to talk me out of them?

We'll start there tomorrow. Not a test. A conversation.

## WITH DAD 3 MINUTES

Ask Him: *Father, what did You say to me this week?* Then: *What do You want me to keep asking You?* Then just be with Him.

## SHARE

One line about your fifth week home.

## YOUR WEEK IN THE APP: HIS NOTES FROM DAYS 29 TO 35, FILLED IN

Same as Day 7: each note he wrote this week, with the day, the "Carry this" line, and the With Dad question. Only days he wrote show up.

## YOUR NOTES ON DAY 35

SUNDAY EVENING, AFTER DAY 35

# THE WEEK 5 EMAIL

Same template as Week 1. Only the seven day lines are new.

**From:** The Journey <jpulley@manaliveexpedition.com>
**Subject:** Week five is in the books. You're caught up.

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Mike,

Five weeks home. Maybe you did every day. Maybe you missed a few. Either way, you're not behind, and there's nothing to apologize for. Here's the heart of the week, in case any of it slipped by.

**Day 29, Not Alone There.** The worst part of the wound was being alone in it. You invited Jesus in. You don't have to see anything. Inviting Him is enough. Reread Day 29 ›

**Day 30, What Is True.** Name what the wound told you, tell Him you're done with it, then ask Him what's true. The truth comes from Him, not from a nicer sentence you make up. Reread Day 30 ›

**Day 31, Still Need a Father.** No man graduates from fathering. Even a great dad only takes you partway. Father me in this. Reread Day 31 ›

**Day 32, My Name Is Gladiator.** You're not a job with a man inside it. You bring the man into the role. The role isn't the name. Reread Day 32 ›

**Day 33, The Yellow Passport.** Old names turn into scripts. Your wound doesn't get naming rights, and neither do your trophies. Only your Father sees the whole man. Reread Day 33 ›

**Day 34, What Do You Think of Me?** Ten minutes alone with one question. He may answer with a name, a word, a picture, or quiet for now. Either way, you asked, and that's a son talking to his Father. Reread Day 34 ›

**Day 35, Not a Test.** Nothing yet isn't failure. The name was never the point. The Father is. Reread Day 35 ›

Your notes from this week are waiting for you on Day 35. Only you can see them.

Read your week ›

That's the week. If you just read this, you're caught up. Tomorrow we start fresh.

Strength and Honor,
Pulley

FOR YOUR REVIEW

# DECISIONS MADE IN THIS DRAFT

- **One week, and it's about the name.** Healing gets Days 29 and 30 only: invite Jesus in, then name the message, break agreement, ask what is true. Days 31 to 35 follow the New Name session in camp order: fathering, Gladiator, false names and Les Mis, the ask, the landing.
- **Left out of the healing days on purpose:** grieving the wound, forgiveness, the younger self, and asking Jesus to fill the place. Forgiveness especially needs room and care (it never excuses abuse or requires reconciling with an unsafe person), so it waits for a Healing Prayer week if you build one.
- **Agreement language stays inside the prayer.** Day 30 uses "done agreeing with it" and "I don't believe that anymore" the way the camp prayer does, but never defines an agreement or turns it into a daily tactic. Battle teaches that next week. Confirm "What's true, Jesus?" as a handle is okay alongside Battle's "ask for truth" step.
- **Held story used: NEW NAME,** on Day 34 (Saturday, 10 minutes). Written in your voice from the facts you gave. Please check God's words as written, and "during a session at camp." The draft doesn't say whether you also received a single name. If you did, Day 35's story slot is the place for it.
- **The app never gives a name or hints at one.** Every asking day says it may come as a name, word, phrase, picture, verse, or unfold over time, and that nothing yet is not failure. Day 35 is built around "what about the guys who didn't get a name?"
- **Optional jail story slot** on Day 33, next to Valjean's yellow passport. If you'd rather not, the same slot works with any name you lived under.
- **No public naming.** Old names are recognition only. No Share prompt asks for a label or a received name. Friday's share is a shout-out to a man whose words gave life.
- **No formulas for hearing God.** The posture throughout: ask, listen, write, don't force, don't grade, keep asking.
- **No other speaker's stories.** Readings name the camp moments (the healing prayer, fathering, Gladiator's "My name is Gladiator," Valjean's passport, the thirty minutes) but not any speaker's personal story, since those change camp to camp.
- **Day 29 has one safety line:** if it gets heavy, call one of the guys. Consider whether you also want a counselor mentioned.

- **Day 35 bridge:** "If my Father has good words for me, why does something keep trying to talk me out of them?" Points toward Battle without teaching it.
- **With Dad** is 5 minutes on weekdays, 10 on Saturday (framed as a small Covenant of Silence), 3 on Sunday.

### OVERALL NOTES ON WEEK 5